The Haunted House

The mission



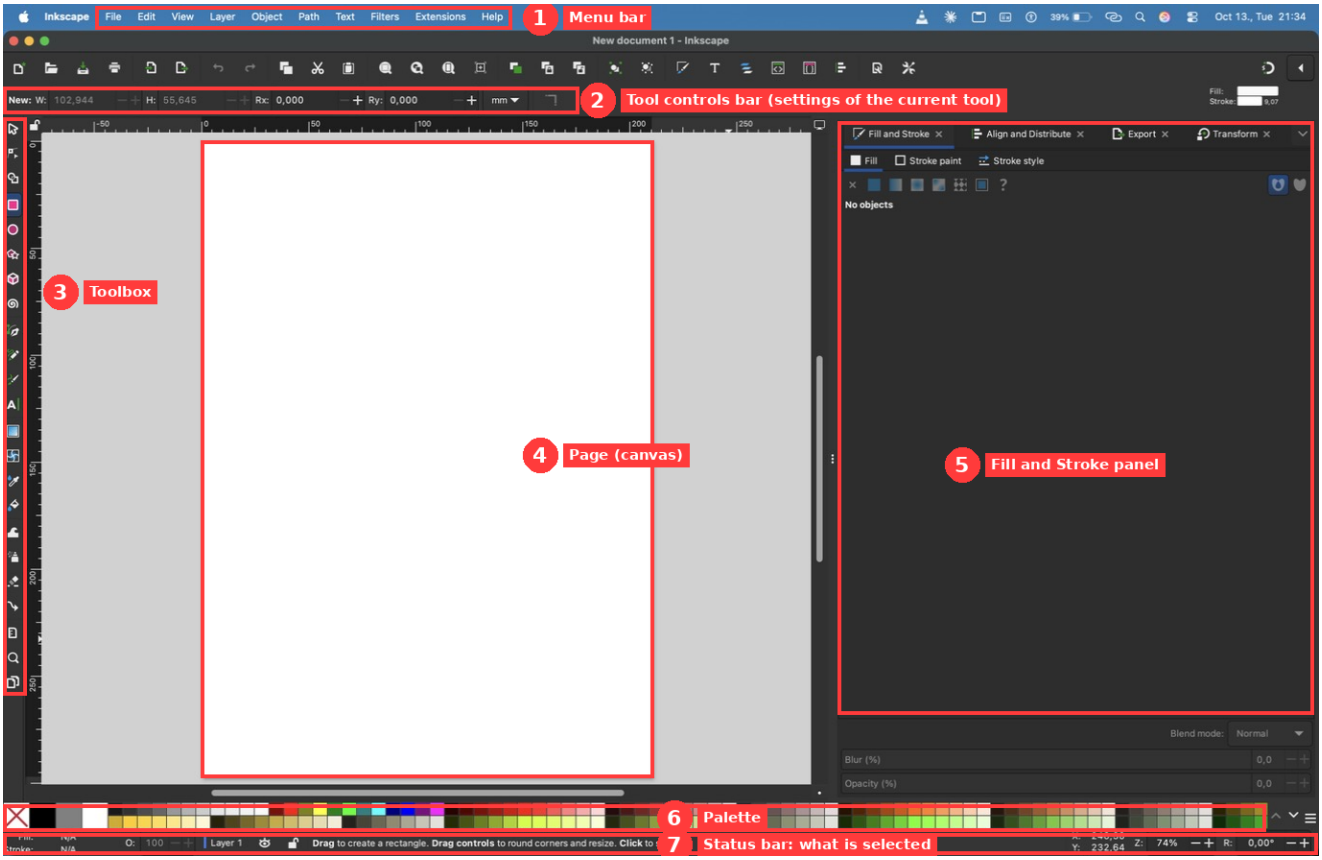
At the end of the lane stands a house nobody enters. Tonight you design the poster for the Haunted House night. You only need what you already know: shapes, fill and stroke, the Node tool, Union, Intersection and Difference.

No keyboard shortcuts – every command is in a menu or on a toolbar. Hand in an SVG and a PNG. Colours and sizes are up to you; what counts is that every element is made with the operation in the table.

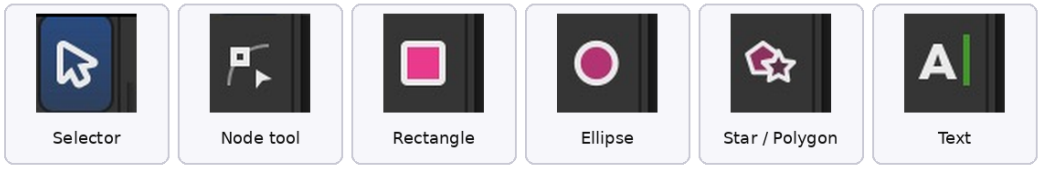
Element	How it is made	What you practise
Night sky, stars, moon	Rectangle tool, Star tool, Ellipse tool	basic shapes, fill, stroke
Hill	wide ellipse + rectangle → Intersection	Intersection
House silhouette	rectangle + triangle → Union	Union
Glowing windows and door	small shapes → Union → Difference from the house; yellow rectangle behind	Union, Difference, stacking order
Ghost	circle + rectangle → Union; three circles → Difference	Union, Difference
Leaning tree	rectangle → path → nodes	Node tool
Fence	one plank → Edit ▸ Duplicate × 4 → a rail across them	duplicating, arranging

Before you start

This is Inkscape. You will use the numbered parts: menu bar, tool controls bar, toolbox, page, Fill and Stroke panel, palette, status bar.



The tools you will use (toolbox on the left edge – hover an icon to see its name):



File ▸ New a new document

File ▸ Save As... surname_hauntedhouse.svg – then File ▸ Save every few minutes

View ▸ Zoom ▸ Zoom Page shows the whole page

Three things to remember:

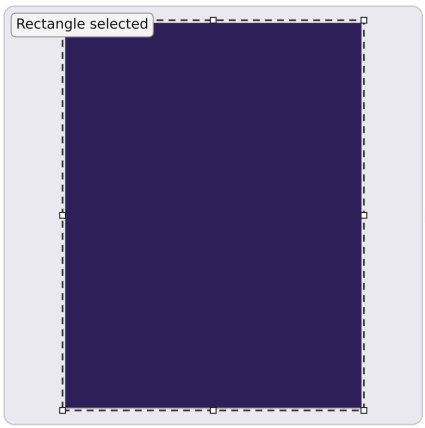
+ **Object ▸ Fill and Stroke...** palette swatch = fill colour; stroke colour and on/off in Fill and Stroke, Stroke paint tab

+ **Shift** select several objects: click the first, Shift + click the others (the status bar counts them)

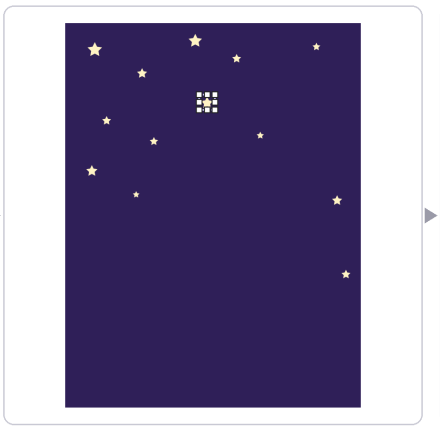
Path ▸ Difference the object on TOP is cut out of the one underneath – exactly 2 objects selected

No keyboard shortcuts in this worksheet – every command is in a menu or on a toolbar. The caption under each picture tells you which tool, colour or menu to use.

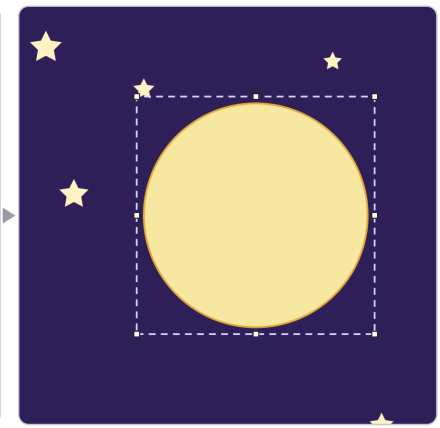
Step 1 – Night sky, stars and moon



1 → Drag over the whole page.
Click dark purple in the palette.



2 New: Corners: 5 Star mode, Corners 5. Drag out about 8 stars. Click pale yellow.

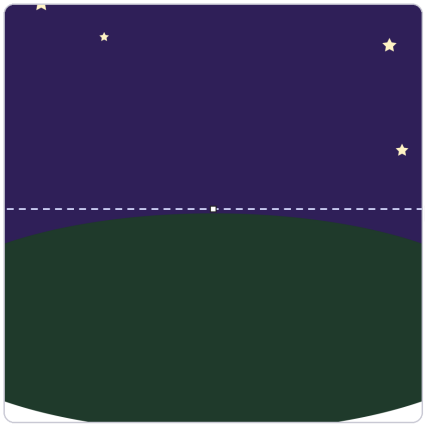


3 → + Big circle, top right: pale yellow.
Stroke paint tab ▸ orange.

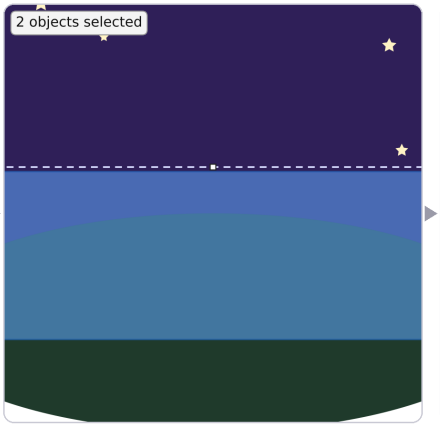
Leave the bottom third of the page empty – the hill, the house and the tree go there.

Step 2 – Hill

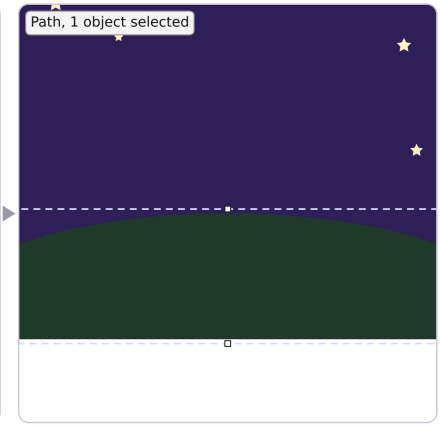
Intersection keeps only the part the two shapes share – here it trims the ellipse to the page.



1 → Very wide ellipse at the bottom, half of it below the page. Dark green.



2 → + Shift Rectangle from the page bottom up over the hill. Select both.

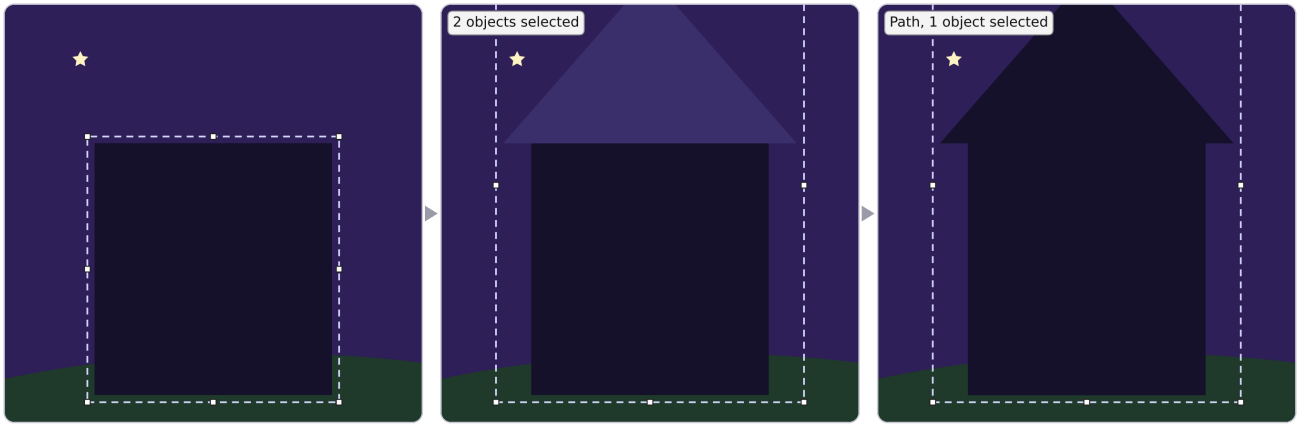


3 Path ▸ Intersection Only the shared part stays: a hill with a flat bottom.

If the hill vanished: the rectangle did not overlap the ellipse. Edit ▸ Undo and draw the rectangle over the top half of the ellipse.

Step 3 – House silhouette

Walls + roof become one shape with Union.



1 → Tall rectangle standing on the hill = the walls. Almost black.

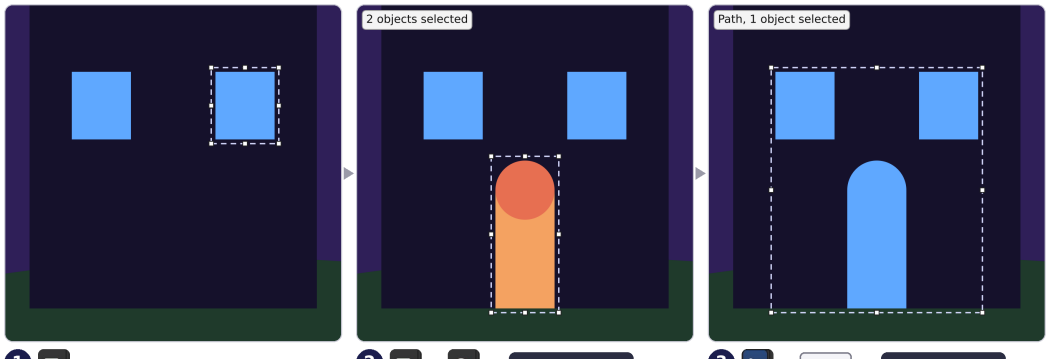
2 Polygon mode, Corners 3. Drag UP from the centre: roof over the walls.

3 + Shift → Path ▸ Union — Select both. Union makes ONE house shape.

The roof must overlap the top of the walls a little, otherwise Union leaves a gap.

Step 4 – Glowing windows

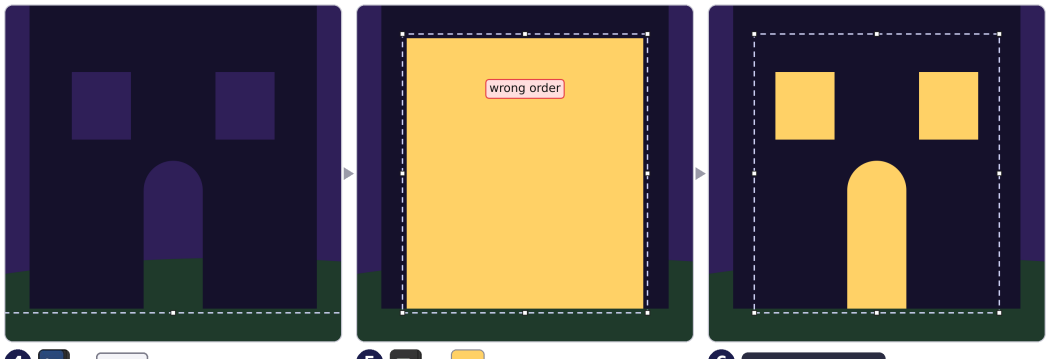
The windows and the door are holes in the house; a yellow rectangle behind the house shines through them.



1 Two small rectangles on the walls = windows. Any colour.

2 + → Path ▸ Union — Door: rectangle + circle on its top. Select both ▸ Union.

3 + Shift → Path ▸ Union — Windows + door together: Union ▸ ONE object.



4 + Shift → Path ▸ Difference — Click the house, Shift + click the openings ▸ holes!

5 → Yellow rectangle over the windows and door.

6 Object ▸ Lower — Behind the house: the windows glow.

If the house disappeared instead of the openings: the house was on top. Edit ▸ Undo, click the openings, Object ▸ Raise to Top, try the Difference again.

Step 5 – Ghost

Union builds the body, Difference bites the wavy hem.



1 + → White circle, and a rectangle below it that overlaps it.

2 + Shift → Path ▸ Union — Select both ▸ Union: the ghost body.

3 — Three small circles sitting on the bottom edge. Any colour.



4 Path ▸ Union → + Shift — Union the 3 circles. Then click the ghost, Shift + click them.

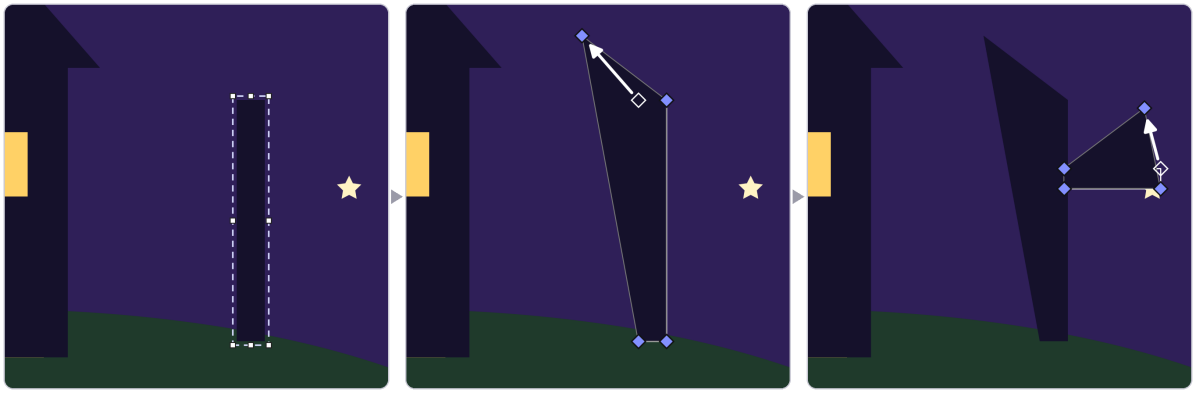
5 Path ▸ Difference — The circles bite out a wavy hem.

6 → — Two small dark circles = the eyes.

The three small circles must sit ON the bottom edge – half inside the ghost, half outside – or the Difference will not bite.

Step 6 – Leaning tree

A rectangle turns into a crooked trunk by moving one corner node.



1 → — Tall thin rectangle on the right = the trunk.

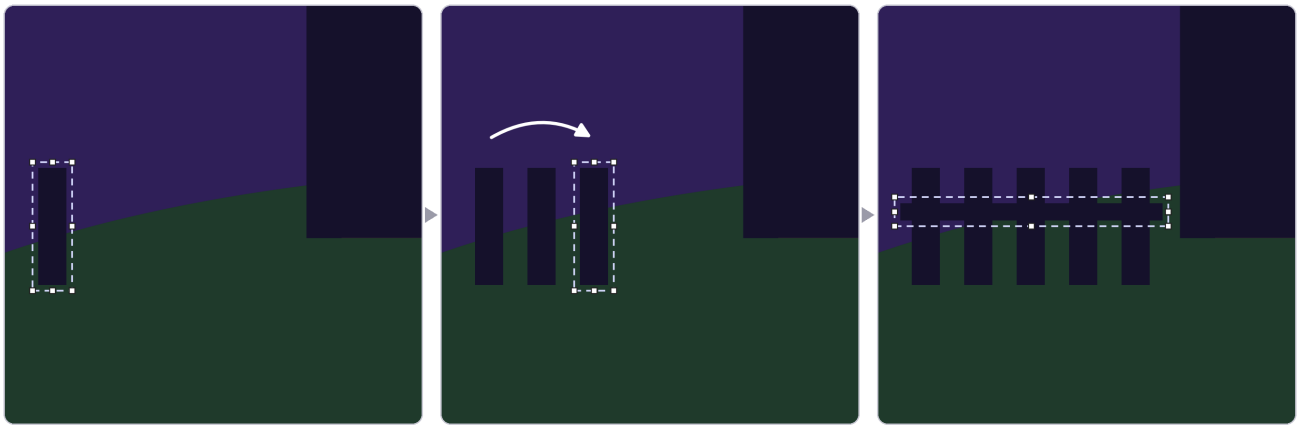
2 Path ▸ Object to Path → — Node tool: drag the top-left node up and left. It leans!

3 → Path ▸ Object to Path → — Thin rectangle = branch. Object to Path, drag its far top node up.

A second branch on the other side: click the branch, Edit ▸ Duplicate, Object ▸ Flip Horizontal, drag it to the left of the trunk. If the whole shape moves when you drag a node, you are still on the Selector – pick the Node tool.

Step 7 – Fence

Draw one plank, then copy it – Edit ▸ Duplicate makes an exact copy on top of the original, ready to drag.



1 → One thin upright rectangle on the hill = a plank.

2 **Edit ▸ Duplicate** → Duplicate, drag the copy to the right. Repeat: 5 planks in a row.

3 One long flat rectangle across the planks = the rail. Done!

If the copy seems to do nothing: it is sitting exactly on the original – just drag it to the right.

Step 8 – Save and hand in

File ▸ Save the SVG file

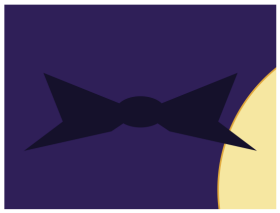
File ▸ Export... choose Page, name it surname_hauntedhouse.png, click Export

Hand in both files: `surname_hauntedhouse.svg` and `surname_hauntedhouse.png`. (Older Inkscape: File ▸ Export PNG Image...)

Bonus – if you have time left

Pick one or more. Each one uses the same operations as the main task.

Task	Recipe
Bat in front of the moon	Small ellipse + a triangle on each side (Polygon mode, 3 corners) → Path ▸ Union → almost black
Pumpkin on the hill	Orange ellipse; three small triangles for the eyes and mouth → Union → Path ▸ Difference from the pumpkin; a darker ellipse behind it (Object ▸ Lower)
Chimney	Small rectangle on the roof → select it with the house → Path ▸ Union
Crescent moon	A second circle over the moon, same colour as the sky, slightly to one side → Path ▸ Difference
Poster title	Text tool (toolbox), click at the top of the page, type HAUNTED HOUSE NIGHT – big letters, pale yellow



Bat: small ellipse + two triangles ▸ Path ▸ Union, in front of the moon



Pumpkin: orange ellipse − triangles ▸ Path ▸ Difference, darker ellipse behind



Crescent: a sky-coloured circle over the moon ▸ Path ▸ Difference



Chimney: small rectangle on the roof ▸ Path ▸ Union with the house

Bonus ideas: bat, pumpkin, crescent moon, chimney

Checklist before handing in

- ☐ The sky covers the whole page
- ☐ At least 8 stars and a moon with an orange stroke
- ☐ The hill has a curved top and a flat bottom (Intersection)
- ☐ The house is ONE object: walls and roof joined (Union)
- ☐ Windows and door are holes, with yellow light behind them (Difference + Object ▸ Lower)
- ☐ The ghost has a wavy hem and two eyes (Union + Difference)
- ☐ The tree leans and has at least one branch (Node tool)
- ☐ A fence of at least 5 planks and a rail (Edit ▸ Duplicate)
- ☐ Both SVG and PNG saved, with your surname in the file name